As usual, Bill grabs the nearest available scrap of paper and scribbles the following diagram on it. “That’s how you define an attribute on a class,” he says.

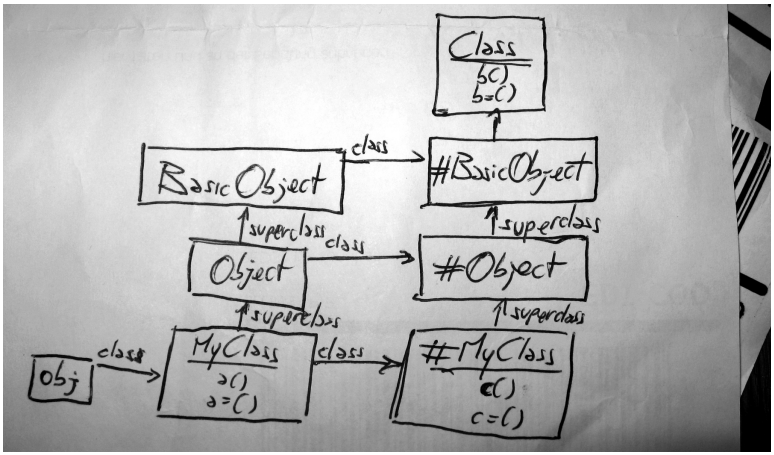



**Figure 9—Class attributes live in the class’s singleton class.**

You can also see another interesting detail in this diagram. The superclass of #BasicObject is none other than good old Class. This fact explains why you can call MyClass.b and MyClass.b=.

Clearly happy with his own explanation, Bill leans back in his comfy chair. “Cool stuff, huh? Now, let’s try a little quiz.”

## Quiz: Module Trouble

*Where you learn that singleton classes and modules mix well with each other.*

Bill decides it’s time for a story: “Every single day, somewhere in the world, a Ruby programmer tries to define a class method by including a module. I tried it myself, but it didn’t work.”

class_definitions/module_trouble_failure.rb

```
module MyModule
  def self.my_method; 'hello'; end
end

class MyClass
  include MyModule
end

MyClass.my_method   # NoMethodError!
```